

sort / uniq / cut

Logs and lists are messy until you order them, collapse duplicates, and pull out columns

Order, dedupe, and columns

- Alphabetical sort is the default; numeric sort with dash-n puts ten after two, not before
- Uniq only collapses neighbors, so sort then uniq is the classic dedupe
- Uniq with dash-c prints a count beside each unique line
- Remember: uniq without sort misses scattered duplicates

Browser lab

Digital Design and Verification Platform

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INTERACTIVE TOOL

sort / uniq / cut

Build column pipelines: sort lines, dedupe with uniq (after sort), and slice fields with cut — the log/report toolkit.

Starter example: `sort names.txt | uniq -c` — sort first so duplicates become adjacent, then count each name.
Try `sort -n numbers.txt` and `cut -d',' -f1 csv_like.txt`.

Load starter example

Challenges 0 / 22 cleared

Quiz: sort: sort orders? Answer: lines

Answer

Show hintCheckNextIdle

Quiz: sortRun starteralice countQuiz: uniquniq alonesort -usort -nQuiz: -nsort -xcut field 1

cut countscut f1,3cut -cERROR countError pipeQuiz: orderUnique namesQuiz: -dLex vs num

Quiz: logsSpace cutwc unique

Pipeline

Command

sort names.txt | uniq -c

Run

sort names.txt → uniq -c

Input / output

names.txtnumbers.txtsample.log

csv_like.txtlog_like.txtfixed.txt

FileLast stdout

sort uniq cut lab

Real shell practice

```
wsl - module12-sort-uniq-cut/examples/sort_uniq

# Track A - real Unix
# real shell session (Track A)

$ cat names.txt
alice
bob
alice
charlie
bob
alice
diana

$ sort names.txt
alice
alice
alice
bob
bob
charlie
diana

$ sort names.txt | uniq
alice
bob
charlie
diana

$ sort names.txt | uniq -c
  3 alice
  2 bob
  1 charlie
  1 diana

$ sort numbers.txt
1
10
100
2
20
5

$ sort -n numbers.txt
1
2
5
10
20
100
```

Real shell — sort and uniq

Real shell practice — try these

```
# cat names.txt — see the raw list with duplicates
cat names.txt
```

```
# sort names.txt — alphabetical order (duplicates become adjacent)
sort names.txt
```

```
# sort names.txt | uniq — unique lines after sorting
sort names.txt | uniq
```

```
# sort names.txt | uniq -c — unique lines with occurrence counts
sort names.txt | uniq -c
```

```
# sort numbers.txt — default (lexicographic) order — often wrong for
numbers
sort numbers.txt
```

Pitfalls to watch

- Running `uniq` alone on an unsorted file skips non-adjacent duplicates, sort first
- Do not confuse lexicographic sort with numeric sort for version numbers or sizes
- And remember

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, finish a few challenges after the starter
- On the real shell, practice sort, uniq dash-c
- When you are ready, take the short quiz, then continue to here-documents and here-strings